Fur, Feathers or Scales? Teacher run card

Open Day Year 1 taster lesson, project-based | 24 minutes (25 max) | 12 children in 3 mixed teams of 4: 4 Lower KG (age 4), 8 Upper KG (age 4 to 5)

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Set up before (15 min)
Three tables or floor mats, each with a tray: 1 sorting mat (A3), 9 animal cards (one set), 3 labelled texture swatches, 2 glue sticks.
Mystery bag: a fur item, a feather, a scaly item (not the group swatches).
Demo: one spare mat on the board or an easel, lion card, Blu Tack.
In your pocket: 12 badges, 3 Team Captain labels.
Handouts (12) by the door. Phone timer ready. Slides on slide 1, full screen.
Seat the groups before you start: each team has 1 or 2 Lower KG children next to Upper KG children. Parents stand behind or to the side.

The lesson in one line
Children answer a real question ("Fur, feathers or scales?") by feeling real textures, sorting nine animals in teams onto a board, presenting it, and checking it. The screen sequences everything; the grey "Teacher:" line at the foot of each slide says what to do next.
What parents should see: a question, hands-on exploration, teamwork, a product, every child presenting, thinking with reasons. In English, with every child contributing at their level.
Goal, every child: feels, sorts, sticks and says a word. **Upper KG:** "The duck has feathers. It is soft."

Min	Slides	Phase	You	Children	Lower KG / Upper KG
0 to 1	1 to 2	**Hello**	Hello chant (wave, clap, sit). "Today we are animal scientists!" Goggles on. Three scientist actions: look, feel, talk.	Copy actions.	Everyone: actions. UKG: say the chant.
1 to 4	3	**Mystery bag**	Three children feel inside and say how it feels. Everyone says soft / smooth / bumpy with the action. Reveal fur, feather, scaly item.	Feel, describe, copy words.	LKG: word + action. UKG: "It feels soft."
4 to 8	4 to 7	**Learn**	Big question with a rhythm. Then fur, feathers, scales: one slide each, pass the swatch, three animals each. "The cat has fur."	Repeat sentences, feel swatches.	LKG: point to the animal named. UKG: "What has fur?"
8 to 9	8 to 9	**Model + rules**	Sort ONE animal on the demo mat, thinking aloud. Four steps with actions: look, feel, talk, stick. Name three Team Captains.	Watch, copy the four actions.	Captains are UKG.
9 to 16	10	**Team time**	7-minute timer. Leave slide 10 up. Circulate: "How does it feel?" "Fur, feathers or scales?" "Why?" 1-minute warning, then "Hands on heads, eyes on me."	Sort 9 cards onto the mat with glue, feeling the swatches, talking.	LKG: feel and stick with help. UKG: sentence before sticking.
16 to 20	11 to 12	**Show time + check**	Each group holds up its mat; every child says one thing. Applause. Then check column by column: thumbs up if it matches. Any difference: feel again and let the group decide.	Present, listen, check.	LKG: point + word. UKG: full sentence + "It is soft."
20 to 22	13	**Think (optional)**	Four new animals: dog, chicken, lizard, sheep. Point to the column, say the word, "Why?" Skip if past 20 minutes.	Point and call out.	UKG: reasons.
22 to 24	14 to 16	**Finish**	"You are animal scientists!" Badge for each child. Handout to each parent. Goodbye chant. Leave slide 16 (What you saw today) on screen.	Chant, wave.	All together.

Running over?
Skip slide 13. Shorten Show time to one sentence per group instead of per child. Protect the last 2 minutes: badge, handout, goodbye.

Finished early?
Slide 13 in full, then "Can your team say all nine?" round the mat.

Attention signals
"Hands on heads, eyes on me." Whisper and they whisper. "Scientists listen" with hand to ear. Never raise your voice; drop it.

Materials, language, differentiation, parents

Item	Where to get it / what works
Fur swatch (x3 + 1 for the bag)	Faux fur offcut from a fabric shop or Taobao (search 仿毛皮 布料); or a fluffy sock, a plush toy, a fleece glove.
Feather swatch (x3 + 1)	Bag of craft feathers (羽毛 手工) from a stationery or craft shop; tape 4 or 5 to a card so they can be stroked.
Scales swatch (x3 + 1)	Sequin fabric (亮片布) or snakeskin-print fabric; a pine cone works well; a textured plastic crocodile or fish toy also works.
Mystery bag	Any opaque cloth bag or a pillowcase.
Per group	Tray, 2 glue sticks (or Blu Tack if mats are laminated for reuse), printed A3 mat, one set of 9 cards.
Printing	3 sorting mats (A3), 4 card pages (3 sets + extension), 1 labels page, 1 badge sheet, 12 parent handouts (A4 double-sided). Laminate mats and cards if time allows.

Cover (feel)	Animals on the cards	Sentence to model
fur (soft and fluffy)	cat, rabbit, lion	The cat has fur. It is soft.
feathers (soft and light)	duck, owl, parrot	The duck has feathers. It is soft.
scales (bumpy and hard)	fish, snake, crocodile	The fish has scales. It is bumpy.
Texture words	soft (stroke your arm), smooth (slide palms), bumpy (tap fingertips along your arm). Slide 13 extras: dog, chicken, lizard, sheep (wool is fur).	

Lower KG (four 4-year-olds, one or two per team)
Success is feeling, sticking and saying a word. Put a card in their hand and the swatch under their fingers; let them stick. Never question a Lower KG child alone in front of the room; at Show time they point to an animal and say the cover word while you say the sentence with them. Sit them beside a confident Upper KG child, not beside each other.

Upper KG (eight 4 to 5-year-olds)
Push for the sentence before they stick: "The owl has feathers." Then the reason: "It is soft." Team Captains hand out one card at a time so everyone gets turns. At Show time they present a full sentence each. On slide 12, let them do the disagreeing: "Bumpy or soft? Feel again."

While you circulate (7 minutes)
Ask in this order, every table: "How does it feel?" then "Fur, feathers or scales?" then "Why?" Praise the thinking, not the answer: "Good feeling, good checking." If a card is in the wrong place, do not move it; ask "Are you sure? Feel again." A group that finishes says all nine sentences round the mat.
If one group falls apart: sit with them for a minute, hand out the cards yourself, keep the other two going with "Scientists, keep sorting!"

Three things to say to parents afterwards
1. "Every child used English to do something real: feel, sort, decide, explain."
2. "You saw a 4-year-old and a 5-year-old do the same task at different levels. That is how Year 1 works."
3. "This is a 25-minute version of a Year 1 project. In Year 1 it runs for a week: a question, an investigation, a product and a presentation, with phonics, reading and maths every day alongside."
The handout says this in English and Chinese. Admissions can take the questions about the two streams.